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Google reshapes into hardware company with Pixel phone

Google has unveiled its first ever 'made by Google' smartphone, called the Pixel. The new handset has brought the search giant into the booming smartphone hardware market, which already has Apple and Samsung as the leaders.

The Google Pixel is the world's first smartphone with the Android 7.1 Nougat OS. It includes Google Assistant, which lets users have natural conversations with Google and find answers to their real-life questions. Additionally, Google is offering pre-installed Google Duo and Allo apps to give an advanced communication experience.

Developers would get a chance to integrate their apps with Google Assistant some time in the future. However, the experience is so far limited to Google's core apps and services.

While the software side of Pixel is novel and innovative, its hardware is just another high-end offering. The smartphone comes in two different variants, with 12.7cm (5-inch) and 13.9cm (5.5-inch) AMOLED display options. Additionally, there is the latest Qualcomm Snapdragon 821 chipset and up to 128GB of storage.

The phone also comes with a 12.3-megapixel primary camera sensor with PDAF and LDAF technologies and an f/2.0 aperture. Google claims that these inputs enable the smartphone to offer the 'best rear camera' experience.

The Pixel starts at US$ 649 in the US (₹ 57,000 in India) to rival Apple iPhone 7 and Samsung Galaxy S7.

Although the Pixel is a fresh offering in the smartphone market, it is not the first attempt by Google. The company had earlier launched several Android based mobile devices under its Nexus brand. Likewise, it had even acquired Motorola in 2011 (which it later sold to Lenovo in 2014) to manufacture smartphones with a vanilla Android experience.

That being said, the Pixel is a major step to help Google reach new levels. It might not attract the masses but could enable the company to make a dent in the smartphone market, which is predicted to hit US$ 2 billion in sales in 2020.

Open source YetaWF offers a custom Web development experience

Enabling easy development of websites, Softel vdm Inc, a maker of programmer productivity tools, has launched YetaWF. The open source toolkit is designed to offer speed, efficiency and minimal administration for custom Web development.

YetaWF, which is a short form of 'Yet another Web Framework', has been in development over the last six years and is still available as a beta version. The framework is powered by ASP.Net MVC 5 and integrates with Visual Studio to

SUSE ties up with Nashik-based ESDS, a cloud services provider

SUSE has announced its partnership with Nashik-based cloud hosting firm, Exuberant Support for Data Services (ESDS), to offer its hosted services in India. Under the terms of the agreement, both the companies will jointly offer enterprise clients an extensive computing environment to run their business-critical applications and workloads.

With the new announcement, ESDS has become the very first Indian cloud services partner for SUSE. "We are very excited to have an Indian cloud services provider to cater to our customer base in the local market," said Rajarshi Bhattacharyya, country head at SUSE India, in a statement. "This is part of our efforts to encourage entrepreneurs in the country to build highly competitive products locally and support Make in India," he added.

The latest partnership enables ESDS to offer its open source products in the public cloud along with SUSE Linux Enterprise Server. The cloud provider's eNlight Cloud is its in-house cloud platform with capabilities like automatically scaling CPU and RAM on-demand. This could become a popular solution for enterprise-level open source deployments in the Indian market.

"We believe that our partnership with SUSE will enable us to capture a bigger share of the market and help us to compete with global giants in the cloud space," stated Piyush Somani, founder, MD and CEO of ESDS.

In addition to ESDS from India, SUSE has partnered with some major global cloud giants including Amazon, Microsoft's Azure, Rackspace and Verizon, among others.